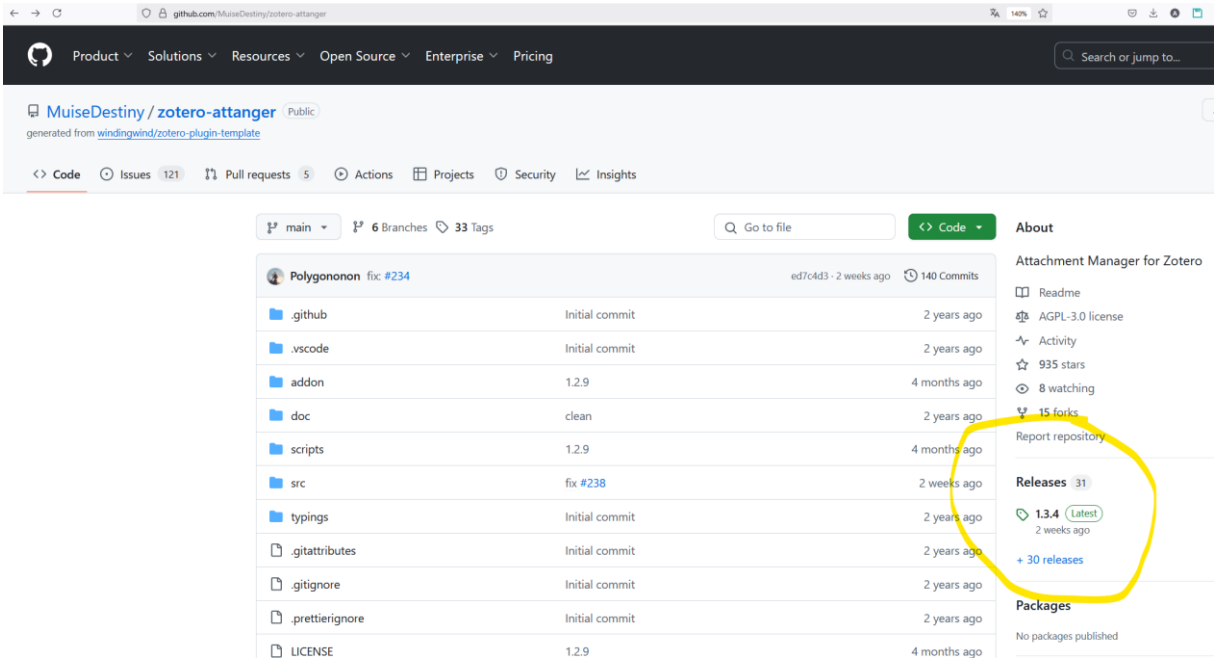
Installation Guide Zotero

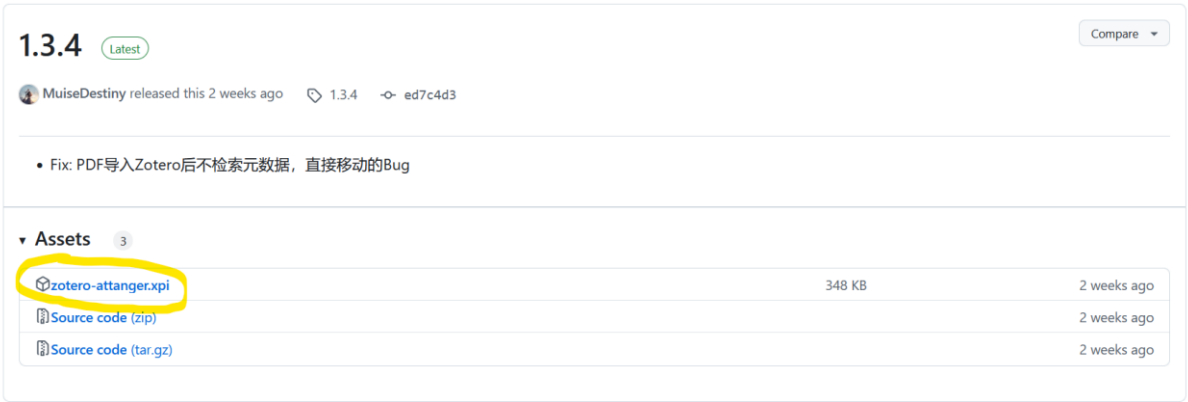
☐**Download and install Zotero from https://www.zotero.org/**

☐**Download the Plugin "Attanger" from https://github.com/MuiseDestiny/zotero-attanger**

1. Click on "Latest Releases"

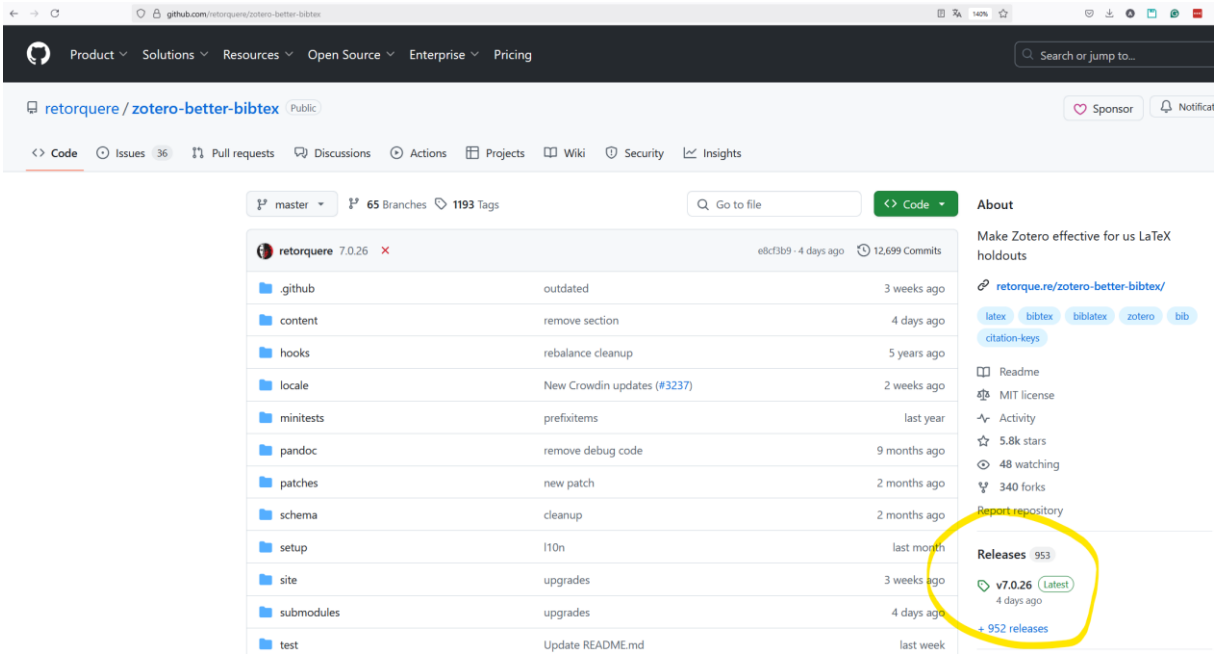


2. Download the .xpi file

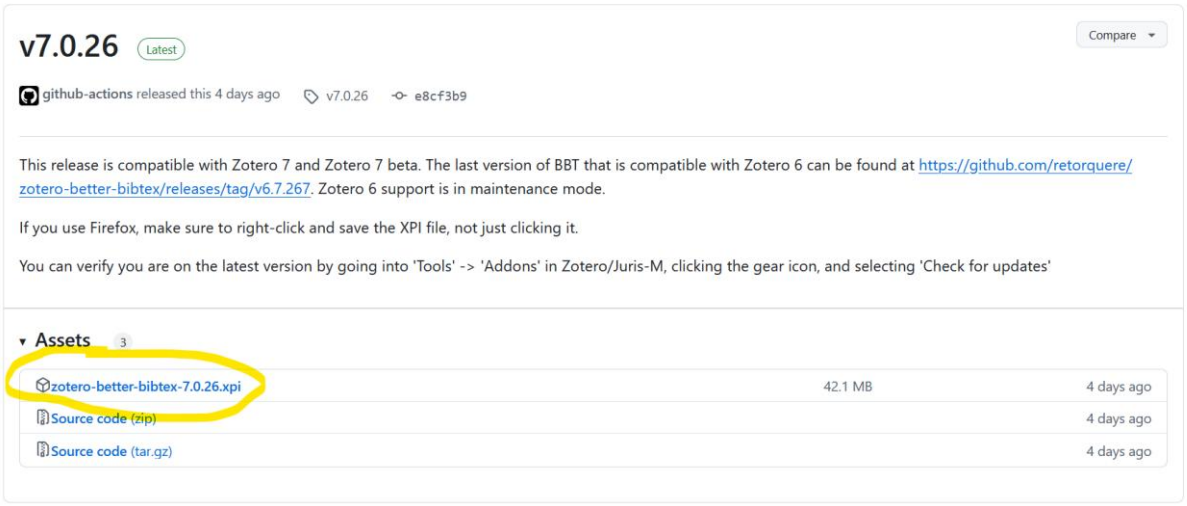


☐ **Download the Add-on "Better BibTex" from https://github.com/retorquere/zotero-better-bibtex**

1. Click on "Latest Releases"



2. Download the .xpi file

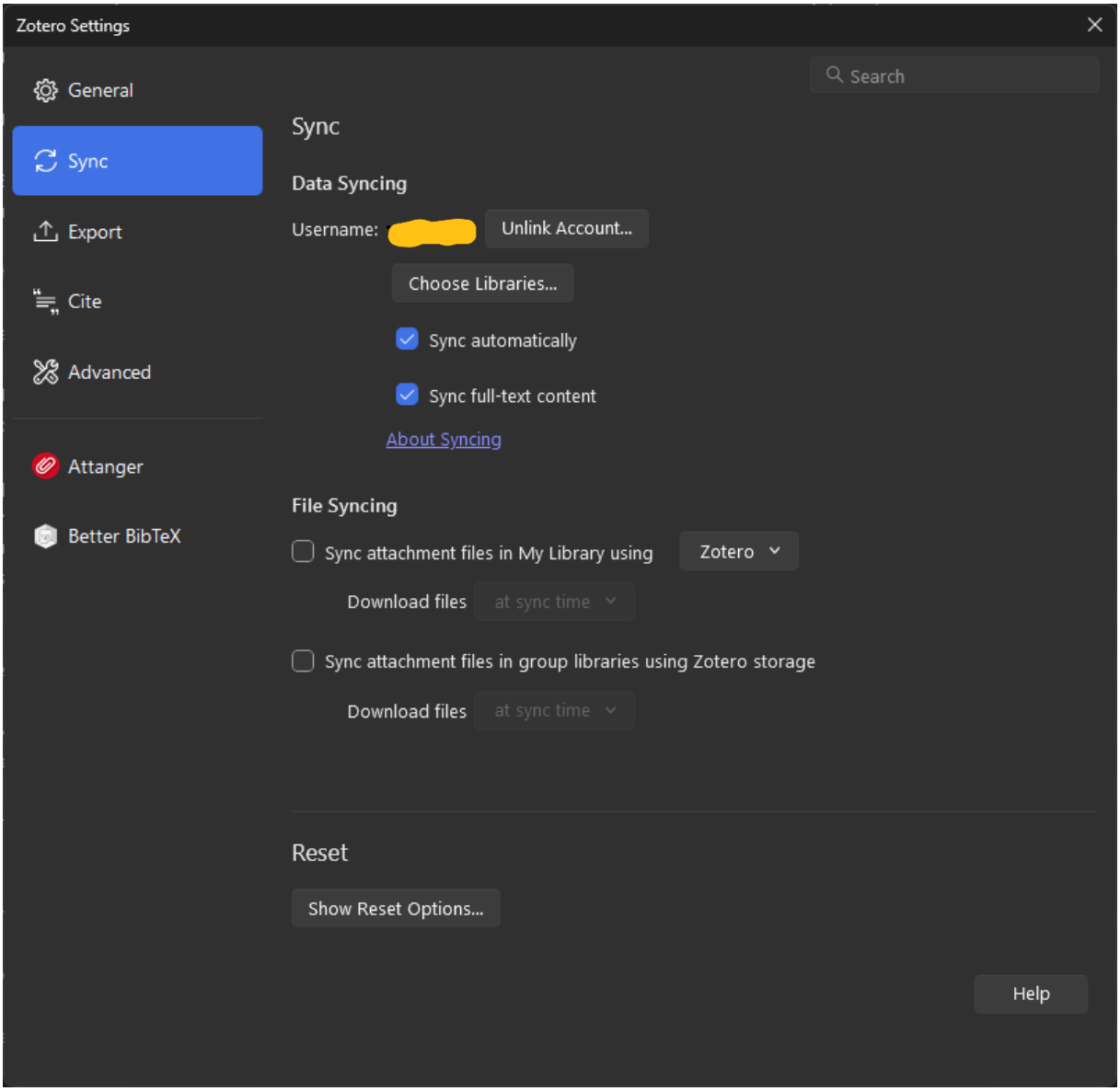


☐ **Open Zotero and install both Plugins**

1. Go to Tools / Plugins
2. Click on the cog symbol and choose "Install Plugin From File…"
3. Choose and install both xpi files

☐ **Under Settings / Sync, create an account. If you already have one, log in.**

1. Open an account or log in if you already have one
2. Check “Sync automatically”
3. Check “Sync full-text content”
4. Uncheck everything under “File Syncing”

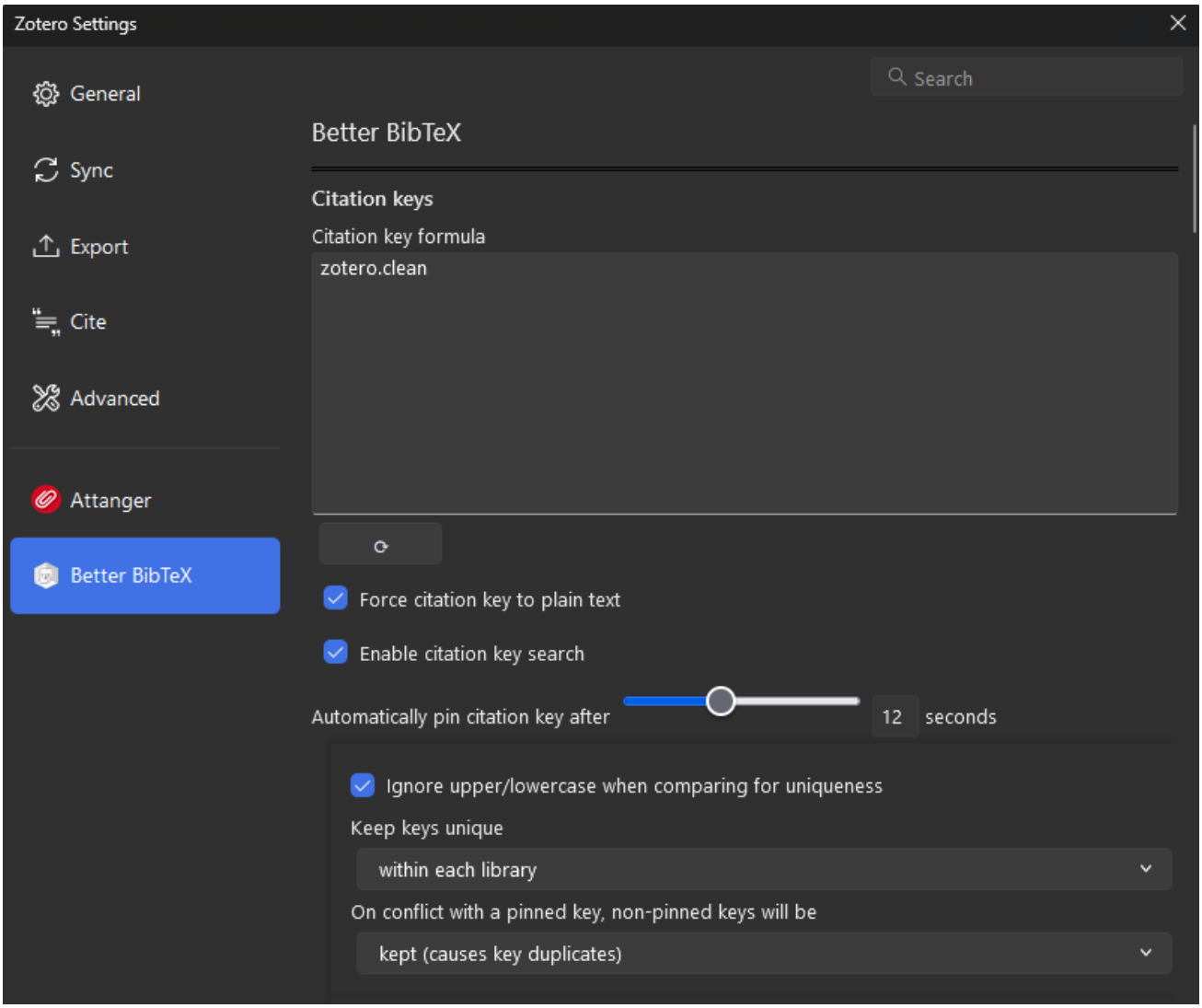


☐ **Prepare Attanger**

1. Go to Settings / Attanger
2. Set under “Source Path” as “Root directory” your default download folder. This is where Attanger picks your PDFs from.
3. Set under “Destination Path” as “Root directory" your Obsidian PDF folder (in the starter kit that is “PDFs”). This is where Attanger will move the renamed PDF to.

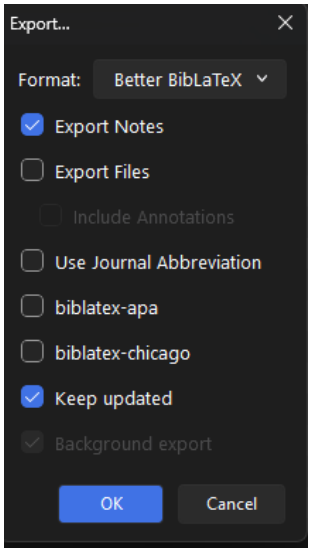
☐ **Prepare Better BibTeX**

1. Go to Settings / Better BibTeX
2. Under “Citation key formula” write “zotero.clean”



☐ **Export Zotero library once**

1. Go to File / Export Library...
2. Choose as Format: Better BibLaTeX
3. Check box “Export Notes”
4. Check box "Keep updated” (This is important!)
5. Save the file in your Obsidian vault root folder as “My Library.bib”



☐ **Link Obsidian with Zotero**

1. Open Obsidian and go to Settings / Citations
2. Choose as “Citation Database Format”: BibLaTeX
3. Copy the path to your database file (“My Library.bib”) into the field “Citation Database path”
4. Add as “Literature note folder” the literature folder in your Obsidian vault (in the starter kit that is “Literature notes”)

☐ **Prepare the templates for literature notes**

1. Set as “literature note title template”: @{{citekey}}
2. Set as “literature note template” your own preferred template. Or copy our suggestion:

```
#### title: {{title}}

##### {{authorString}} {{year}}

{{publisherPlace}} {{publisher}}
{{containerTitle}} {{page}} {{DOI}}
{{isbn}},
[Zotero]({{zoteroSelectURI}})
[PDF]({{citekey}}.pdf)

##### tags:

>[!ABSTRACT]+

>{{abstract}}

---

#### Notes:

{{note}}
```

3. Set as “Markdown primary citation template”: {{authorString}} ({{year}}): {{title}} [[@{{citekey}}]]

4. Set as “Markdown secondary citation template”: @{{citekey}}

☐ **Set Export Settings in Zotero**

1. Go to Settings / Export
2. Set Item Format: Better BibLaTeX
3. Set Note Format: Markdown + Rich Text
4. Check both boxes for "Include Zotero Links"

Now you should be all set!

Try out and insert a reference into an Obsidian note.

From within an open Obsidian note, open the Command Menu (Strg+P / Cmd + P) and choose: “Citations: Insert Literature note link” (or use the shortcut) and choose a reference.

For questions about Zotero please consult: https://www.zotero.org/support/

For questions about Obsidian please consult: https://help.obsidian.md/

For questions about Better BibTex please consult: https://retorque.re/zotero-better-bibtex/installation/